don’t know who among the Democrats might have been a better choice, but it was obvious Mondale picked Geraldine Ferraro simply because he believed there was a “gender gap” where I was concerned and she was a *woman;* I don’t think they picked the most electable woman.

As each day of the general election campaign passed, I found myself getting angrier at Mondale, whose basic theme was that I was a liar: He claimed I said I was not going to raise taxes after the election when in fact I really intended to, already had a plan for it. I kept saying I wouldn’t raise taxes, but he kept saying I was lying and deceiving the public.

Many of our key supporters said to George Bush and me that we had nothing to worry about from the Mondale-Ferraro challenge because the economy was booming and people always voted their pocketbooks. Inflation was down to 4.6 percent, unemployment had plummeted, interest rates were far below the level of four years before, and opinion polls said I had a solid lead over Mondale.

Well, despite what they said, I told myself I was not going to get overconfident. I have never liked to lose and so I set out to campaign as hard as I could for a second term. By no means did I think of myself as a shoo-in, and throughout that summer and fall I was a little edgy.

In a campaign, I always like to act as if I’m one vote behind; overconfidence is a candidate’s worst mistake. I knew anything can happen in an election campaign; it’s just as well I did run scared, because in the view of many people, I nearly blew the whole race during my first debate with Mondale that fall.

I wrote in the diary in early October after the debate in Louisville was over:

> I have to say I lost. I guess I’d crammed so hard on facts and figures in view of the absolutely dishonest things he’d been saying in the campaign I guess I